DESTINY'S CHILD

COMING FROM ONE OF THE MOST PROMINENT business families in the country that is also politically amongst the most powerful, Kaviya Maran has had a headstart in life. That did not stop the daughter of billionaire media magnate and Sun TV owner Kalanithi Maran and CEO of Solar TV Community Restricted Kaveri Maran from striking a path of her own. As CEO and owner of Sunrisers Hyderabad, Kaviya is often seen rooting from the stands for her team, thereby also emerging as a social media hot topic.

The most satisfying job as SRH chief, says Kaviya, is the identifying and nurturing of young, talented cricketers. IPL is one the most competitive sports leagues in the world, with 10 teams continually bettering their game. "With only four teams qualifying for playoffs, it is a challenge to consistently maintain a high level of performance. We have set a very high benchmark for ourselves, being one of the few teams in IPL history to qualify for five consecutive playoffs. While the last couple of years have been difficult, coupled with a complete overhaul post the mega auctions, we aim to work harder to live up to the high expectations of our fans," she says.

Kaviya is aware, though, that this is just the start. "The defining moment in my life was the day I realised that I was being groomed to be the inheritor of a mammoth legacy that my father had built from scratch. That meant I had to be competent, trustworthy and diligent," she says. Kaviya's resolve has much to do with Kalanithi's support. "My father has always encouraged me to pave my own path to success, irrespective of my last name. He once said, 'Do not go where the path may lead, go instead where there is no path and leave a trail'. This has always stuck with me."

Kaviya says that the one big lesson that defines operations at Sun TV Network is to never be satisfied with the status quo. "The network is built on the foundation of hard work and prudently adopting change in technology. There is no fixed path to operational excellence but our aim is to successfully navigate disruptions and always stay ahead of the curve," explains the commerce graduate (2012) from Chennai's Stella Maris College, who has an MBA from the Stern School of Business, New York University (2016).

Kaviya is equally enthused by activities of the Sun Group's philanthropic Sun Foundation. Its initiatives include rehabilitation of visually impaired senior citizens, constructing/ refurbishing schools across India, upgrading amenities in government hospitals and providing free surgeries to the marginalised in partnership with hospitals and NGOs. "This gives me a great sense of fulfilment that is unmatched by any other personal achievement," says the Sun Group heiress. ■

-Amarnath K. Menon

ACCOMPLISHMENT

Her deft handling of the Sunrisers Hyderabad IPL team impressed many and signalled the arrival of a new generation of owners in India's top sports league

FATHER'S WISDOM

"Do not go where the path may lead; go instead where there is no path and leave a trail"

↘ A CRUNCH OF THE BIG APPLE
Her favourite holiday destination is New York

↘ FAVOURITE FOOD
South Indian cuisine

↘ CANINE COMFORT
Two Huskies and a Chow Chow brighten her days at home



Kaviya Kalanithi Maran, *31*
CEO and owner, Sunrisers Hyderabad